

Figure 9: Cartoon, India, *25-5-1907*

If this was the story of the steamers, what about the steam launch? The *Miranda*, meant to convey passengers from ship to shore at the shallow Tuticorin port, was to leave Bristol on 18 May, though we do not know when it actually arrived in Colombo.[98] Evidently, there was much delay and in the absence of their own launch, SSNCo had to charter the *Despatch*, in April, from Ghouse Muhammed, a Kulasekarapatnam merchant based in Colombo.[99] Though envisioned as a stopgap measure, it continued to be used until October 1907, when the *Miranda* finally arrived.[100]